

UFC's Biggest Fight of the Year Is Happening at the White House!

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What if the biggest fight of the year took place right outside the White House? That's exactly what's happening on June 14, when Ilia Topuria faces Justin Gaethje for the **UFC lightweight** championship. The fight is part of the Freedom 250 event, celebrating America's 250th anniversary, and it's also President Trump's 80th birthday. Trump is a huge **UFC** fan and will be there, along with movie stars like Dwayne 'The Rock' Johnson and Adam Sandler. Topuria is **undefeated** and ranked as one of the best fighters in the world, but he hasn't fought in almost a year. He took a break to deal with personal issues. Gaethje won an **interim title** in January by beating Paddy Pimblett, and now he wants the real belt. The fight will be outdoors on the White House lawn, which has never happened before. Some musicians pulled out of the Freedom 250 concerts because they were worried about politics, but the **UFC** show is still on. Who will win? Topuria is the **favorite**, but Gaethje is known for exciting, hard-hitting fights. It's going to be a night to remember!

Word Treasure

UFC -- the biggest mixed martial arts (MMA) company in the world

lightweight -- a weight category for fighters who weigh around 155 pounds

interim -- a temporary championship given when the current champion cannot fight

undefeated -- having never lost a fight

title -- the championship belt that a fighter wins

favorite -- the person most people expect to win a fight or contest

Background you need

President Donald Trump (the U.S. president since 2025) is a well-known fan of the UFC and has attended many fights.

The White House has never hosted an outdoor MMA fight before, making this a historic event.

The UFC is a league where fighters use a mix of boxing, wrestling, and martial arts to win.

Break it down

WHO: Ilia Topuria and Justin Gaethje, two top lightweight fighters

WHAT: They will fight for the UFC lightweight championship at a historic outdoor event

WHERE: On the lawn outside the White House in Washington, D.C.

WHY: It's part of the Freedom 250 celebration for America's 250th anniversary and President Trump's 80th birthday

Why it matters

This event shows how sports, celebrities, and even the President can come together for a big celebration, making history right on the White House lawn.

Test what you remember

1. When is the big UFC fight happening?

- ☐ (A) June 14
- ☐ (B) July 4
- ☐ (C) January 1
- ☐ (D) May 5

2. Where will the fight take place?

- ☐ (A) A sports arena
- ☐ (B) The White House lawn
- ☐ (C) Madison Square Garden
- ☐ (D) A beach

3. Who are the two fighters facing each other?

- ☐ (A) Topuria vs. Gaethje
- ☐ (B) Topuria vs. Pimblett
- ☐ (C) Gaethje vs. Pimblett
- ☐ (D) Trump vs. The Rock

4. What celebration is this fight part of?

- ☐ (A) Freedom 250
- ☐ (B) UFC 300
- ☐ (C) White House Fight Night
- ☐ (D) Trump's Rally

5. Why will President Trump be there?

- ☐ (A) He's a fighter
- ☐ (B) It's his birthday
- ☐ (C) He's the referee
- ☐ (D) It's his favorite sport

6. Which fighter has never lost a fight?

- ☐ (A) Topuria
- ☐ (B) Gaethje
- ☐ (C) Both are undefeated
- ☐ (D) Neither is undefeated

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: A 2: B 3: A 4: A 5: B 6: A

Questions to think about

1. **UFC fans:** They are excited to see a title fight in such a unique and famous location with celebrities like The Rock attending.
2. **Some musicians:** A few performers pulled out of the Freedom 250 concerts because they didn't want to mix music with politics, showing not everyone is happy about the event.
3. **The fighters:** For Topuria and Gaethje, it's a huge chance to become champion in front of the whole world, regardless of where the cage is set up.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):